INCIDENT INVESTIGATION REPORT

Security Operations Center (SOC) | Internal Confidential

1. Executive Summary

On **Feb 13, 2024**, at **2:04AM**, an alert was triggered for unauthorized VPN connection. Investigation confirmed that a malicious actor was trying to login repeatedly from an **untrusted location (Vietnam)**. The attack followed a clear two-stage pattern. Between **1:49AM and 1:59AM**, the attacker engaged in a **brute-force or credential-testing phase**. Starting **2:01AM**, the attacker attempted to bypass the MFA layer. After multiple "Incorrect OTP Code" failures, the logs show a "Response status:200" at 2:02AM, confirming a **successful unauthorized login**. This indicates a successful account compromise, either through **MFA Fatigue or a Successful OTP guess/bypass**.

2. Incident Metadata

Incident ID	INC-2026-225
Report Date	Feb 13, 2024
Incident Category	Unauthorized access – Account Compromise
Severity Level	High
Assigned Analyst	Kesha Patel
Status	Contained

3. Target & Attacker Information

Affected Asset	Monica (Workstation)
Target IP Address	33.33.33.33
Attacker Source IP	113.161.158.12
Attacker Geolocation	Hanoi, Vietnam (ISP: VNPT Corp)
Username	monica@letsdefend.io
URL	https://vpn-letsdefend.io

4. Investigation Timeline

01:49 AM – 01:59 AM: The attacker initiated 14 connection attempts against the VPN gateway, likely testing for account validity or initial password credentials.

02:01 AM: First MFA failure recorded as "Incorrect OTP Code" immediately followed by a successful authentication. Logs show Response Status: 200, indicating a successful login and an established VPN session.

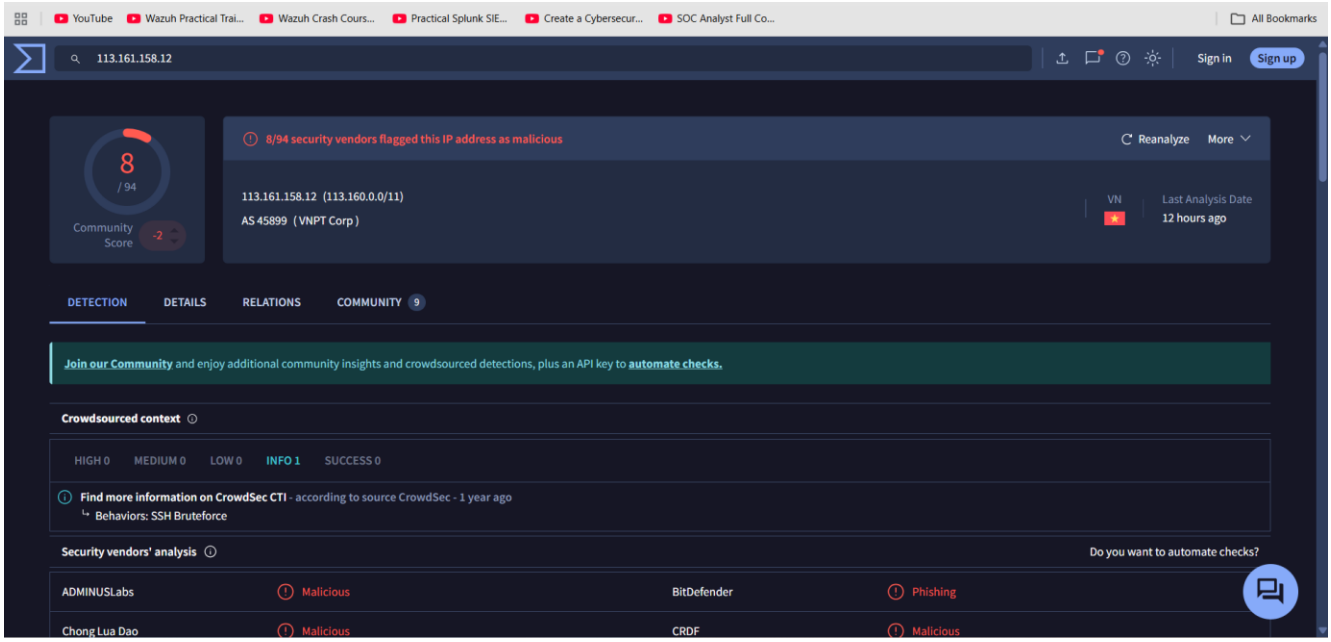
02:02 AM: A second MFA failure occurred. The attacker successfully authenticated. Logs show Response Status: 200, indicating a successful login and an established VPN session.

02:03 AM: One final "Incorrect OTP Code" was also immediately followed by successful authentication. Logs show Response Status: 200, indicating a successful login and an established VPN session.

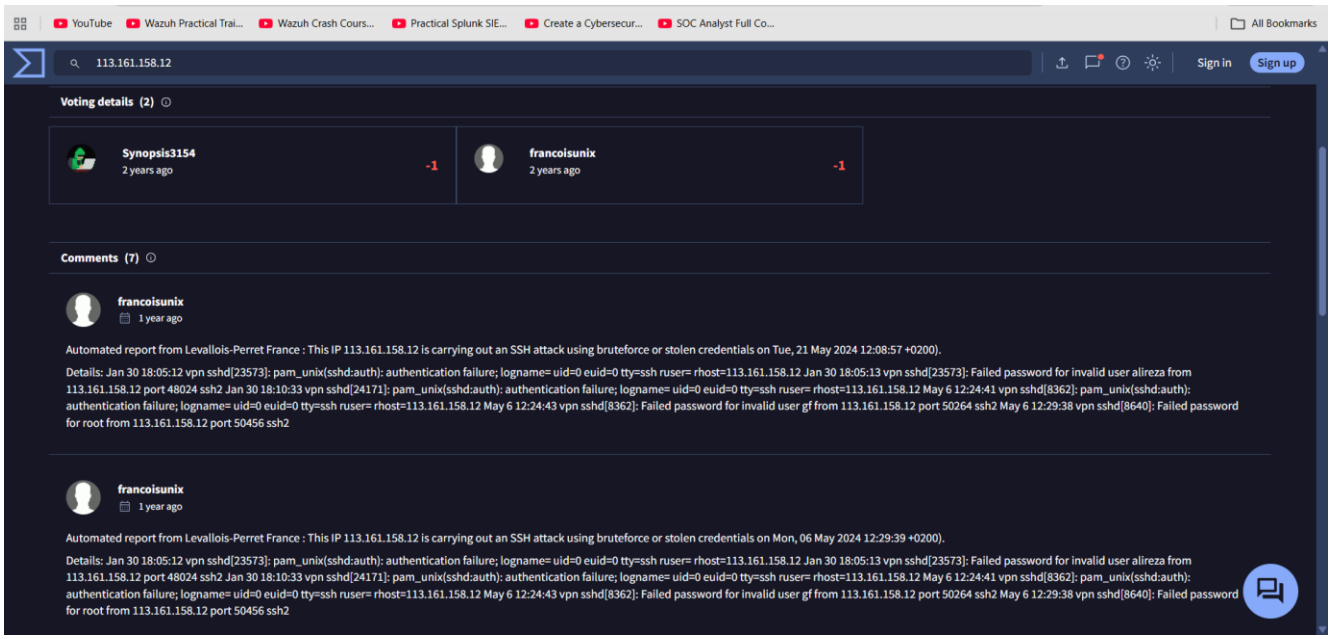
.

5. Evidence (Artifacts)

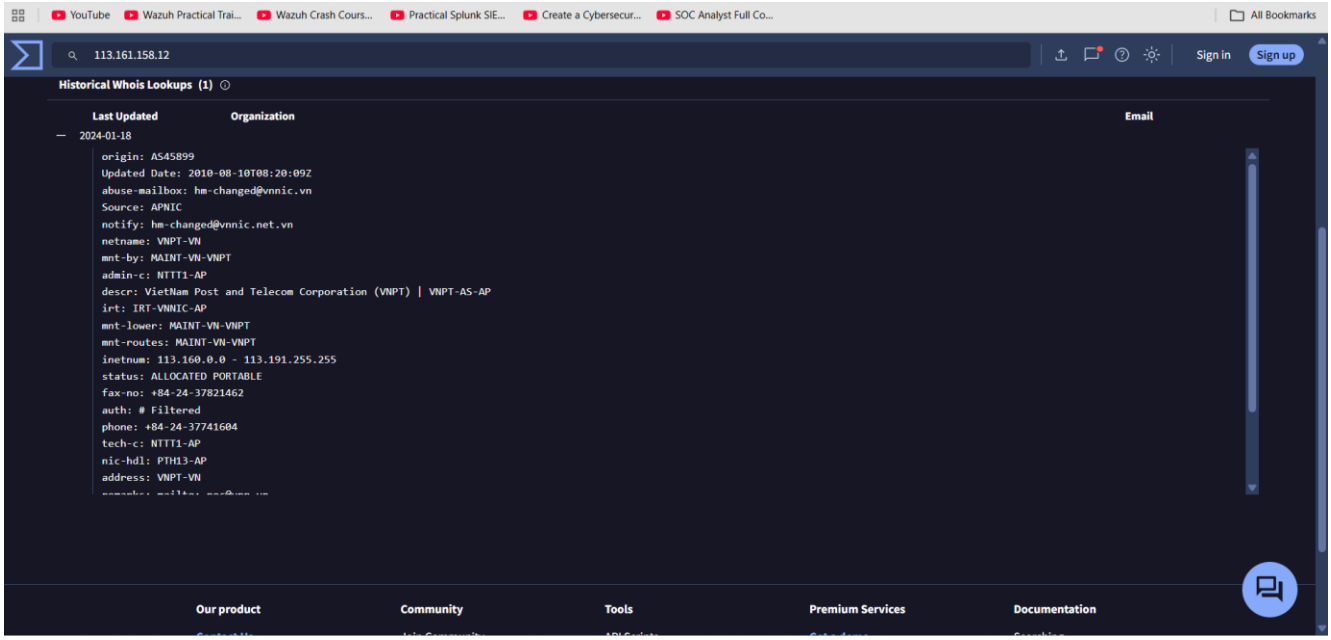
1. Threat Intelligence (Virustotal):

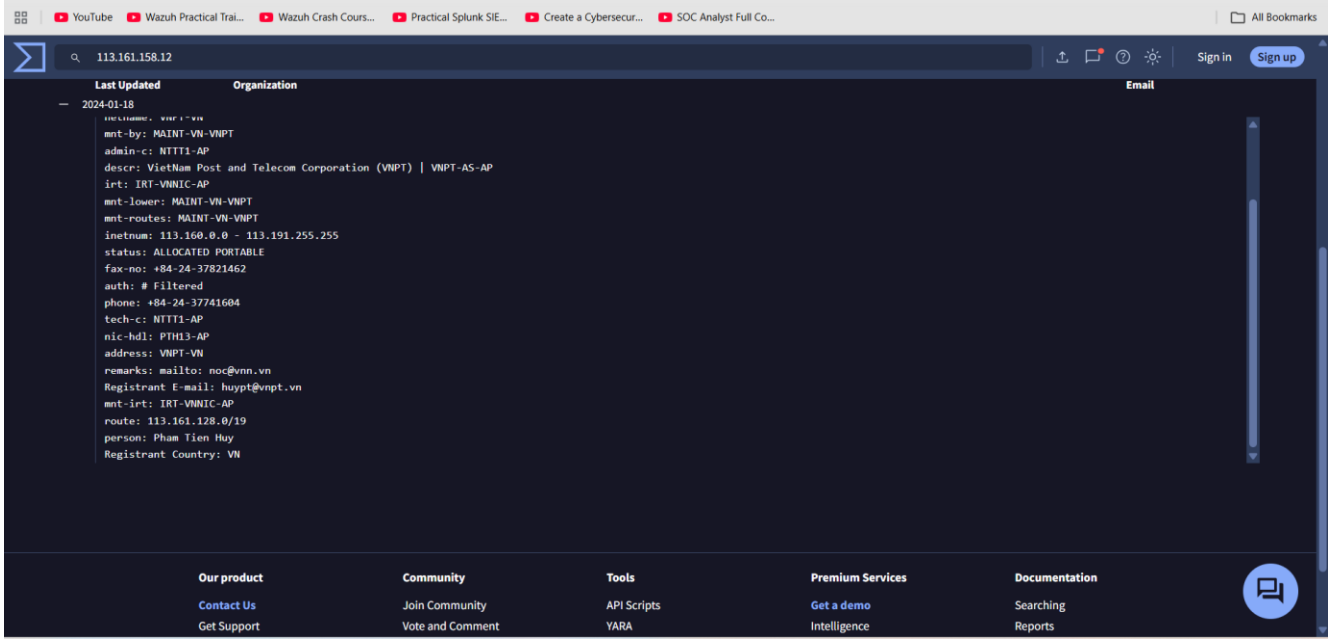


The score shows 8/94 and community score as -2 which means we need to go in depth to confirm if it is malicious or not.

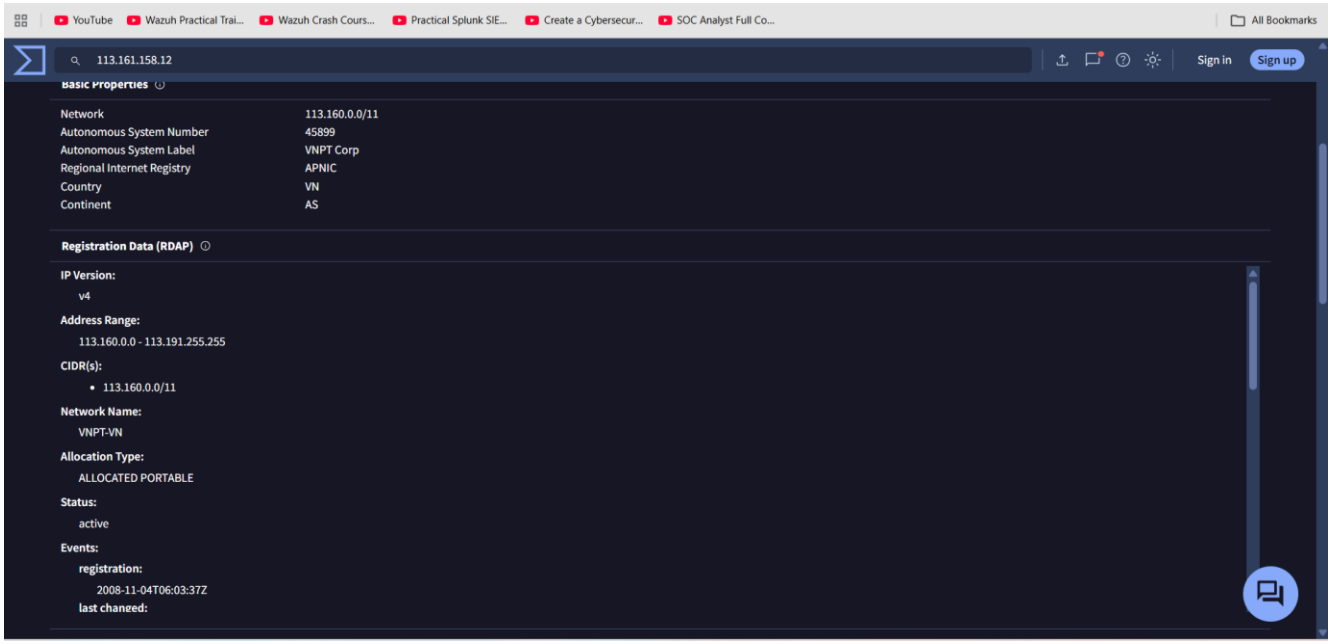


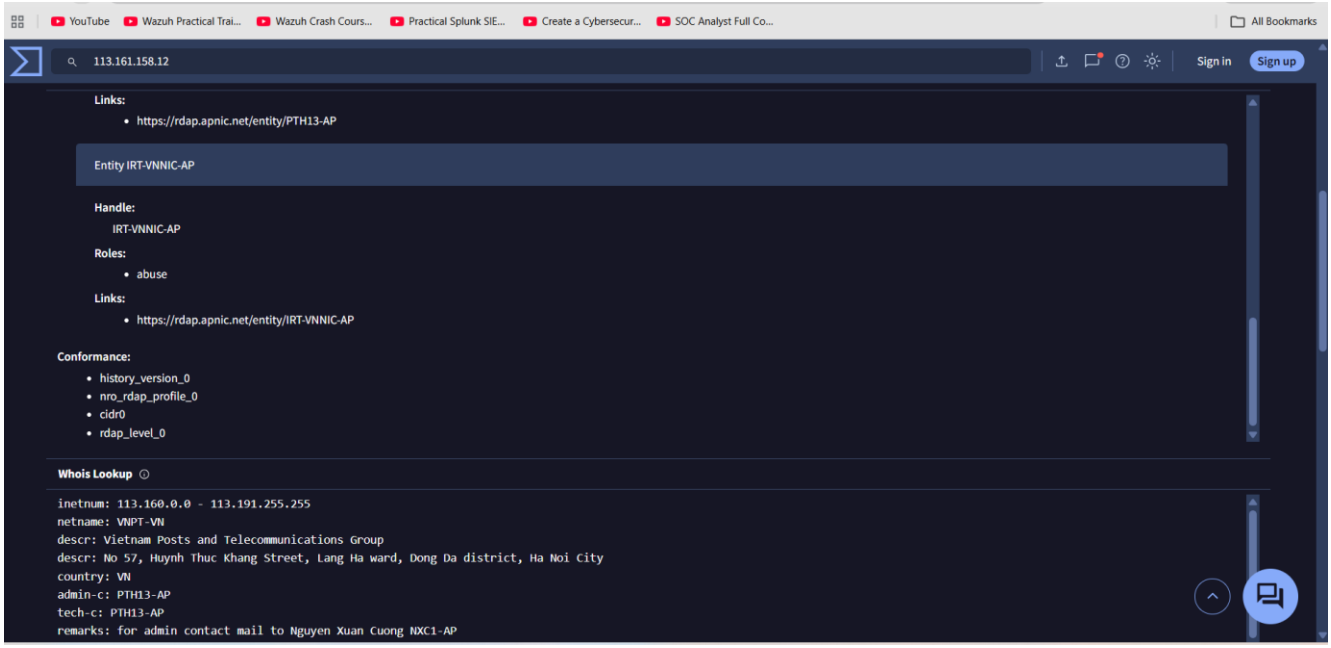
The community tab shows multiple people reporting this IP as malicious. The comments mention SSH attack using brute force or stolen credentials.



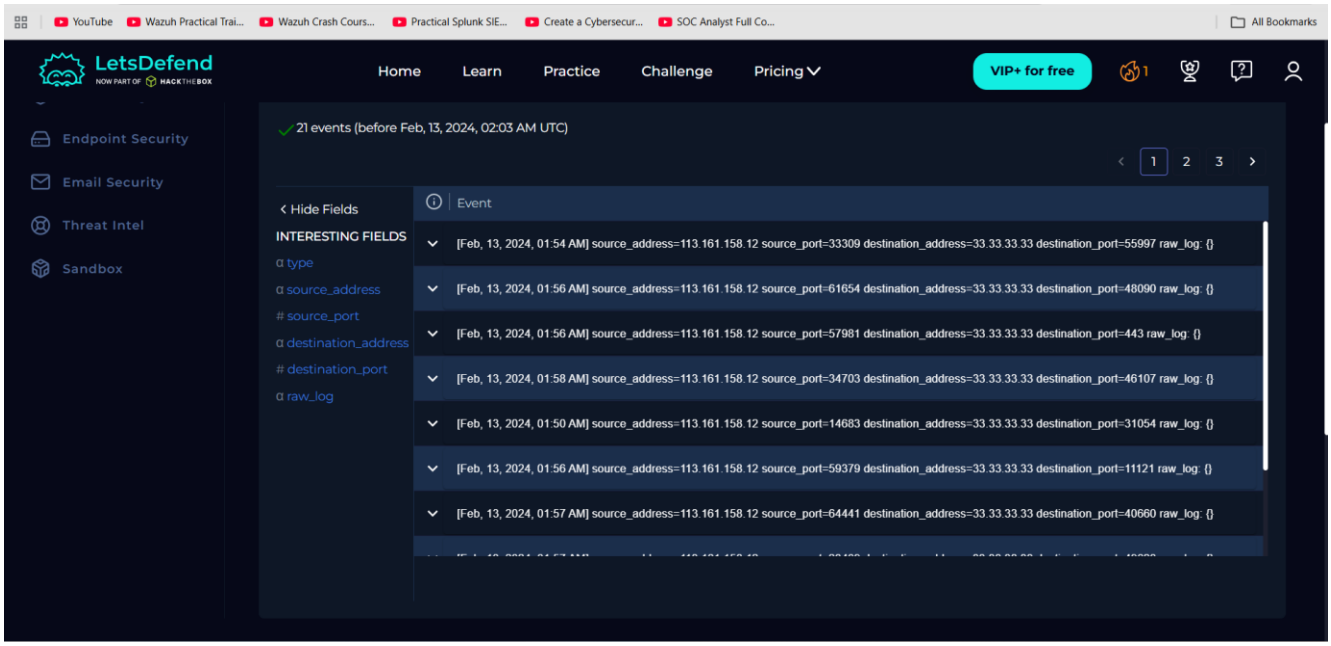


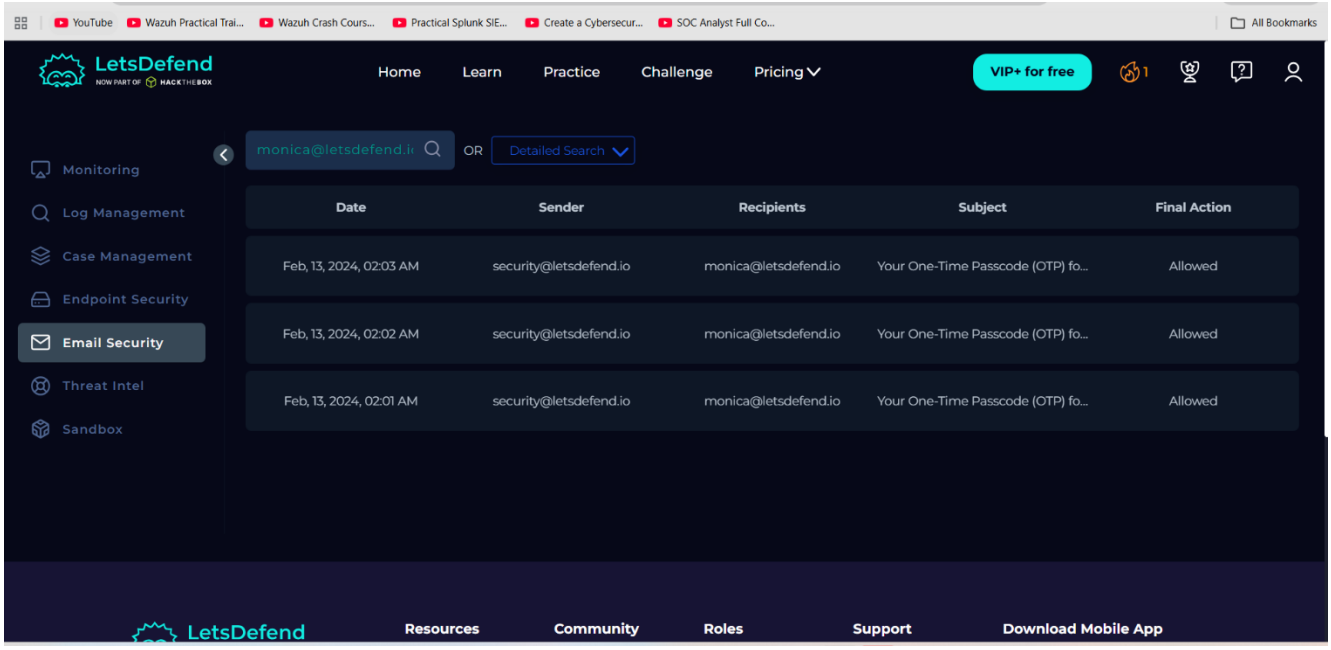
Relations tab – The IP is registered to VNPT Corp in Hanoi, Vietnam and we don't have any email mentioning that Monica was travelling.



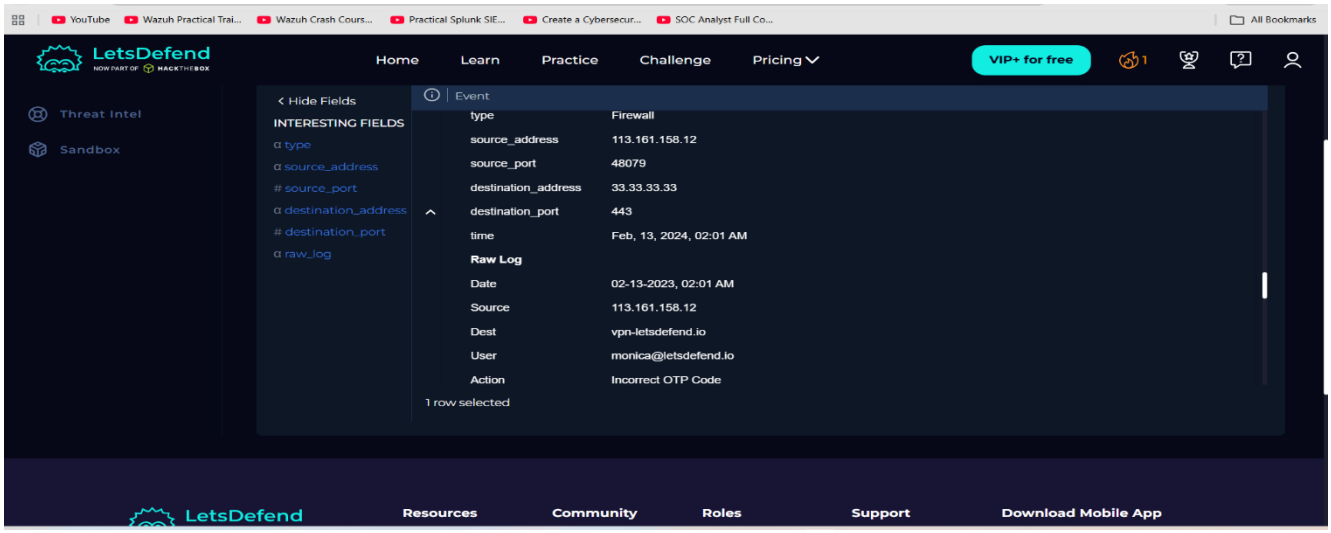


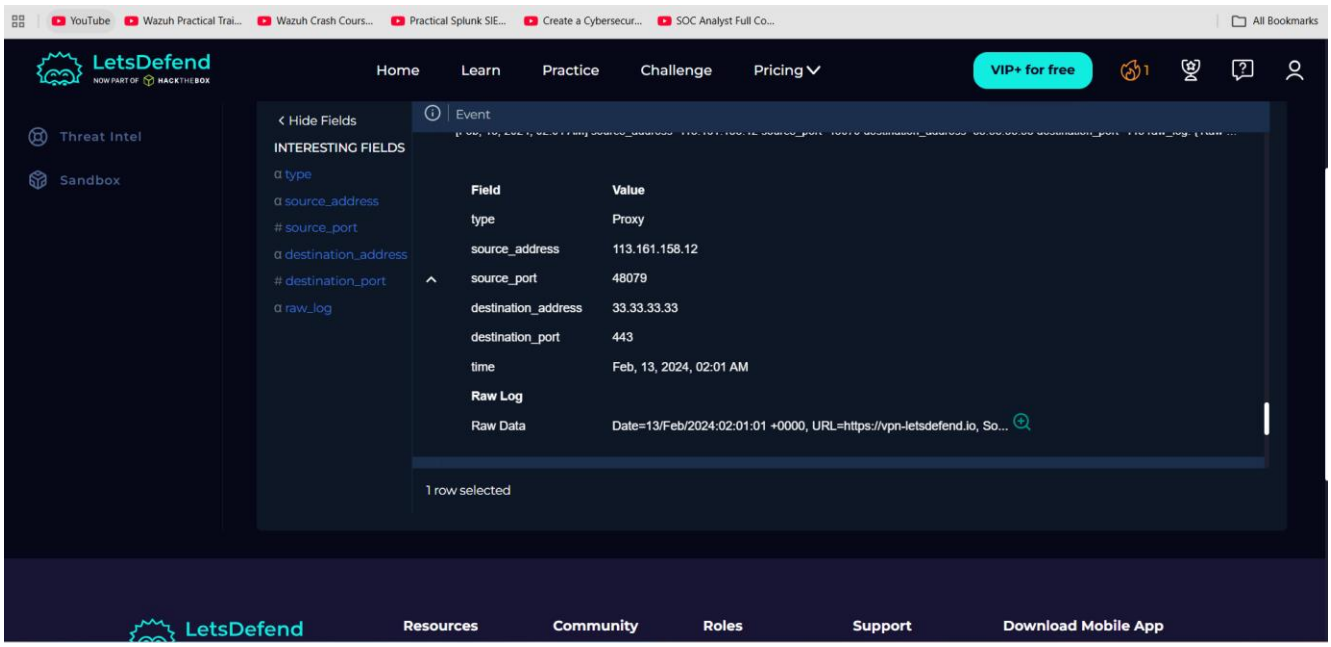
Details tab - IP is registered in Hanoi, Vietnam and the owner is VNPT Corp.



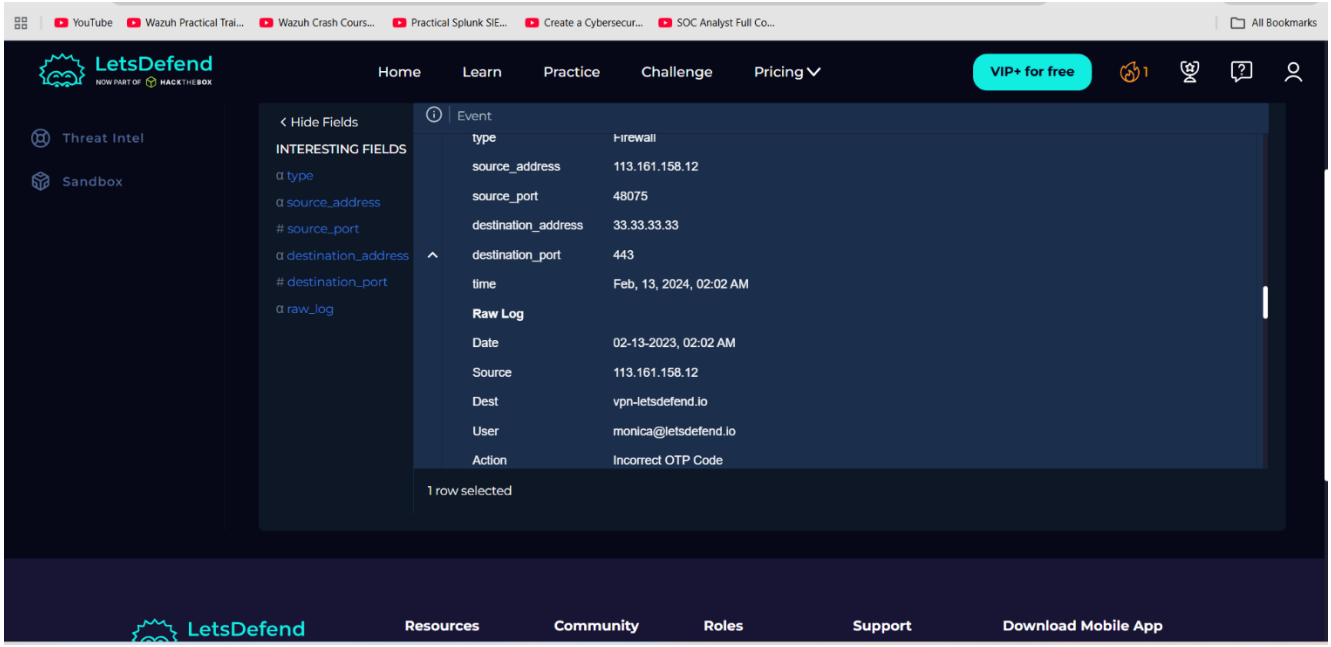


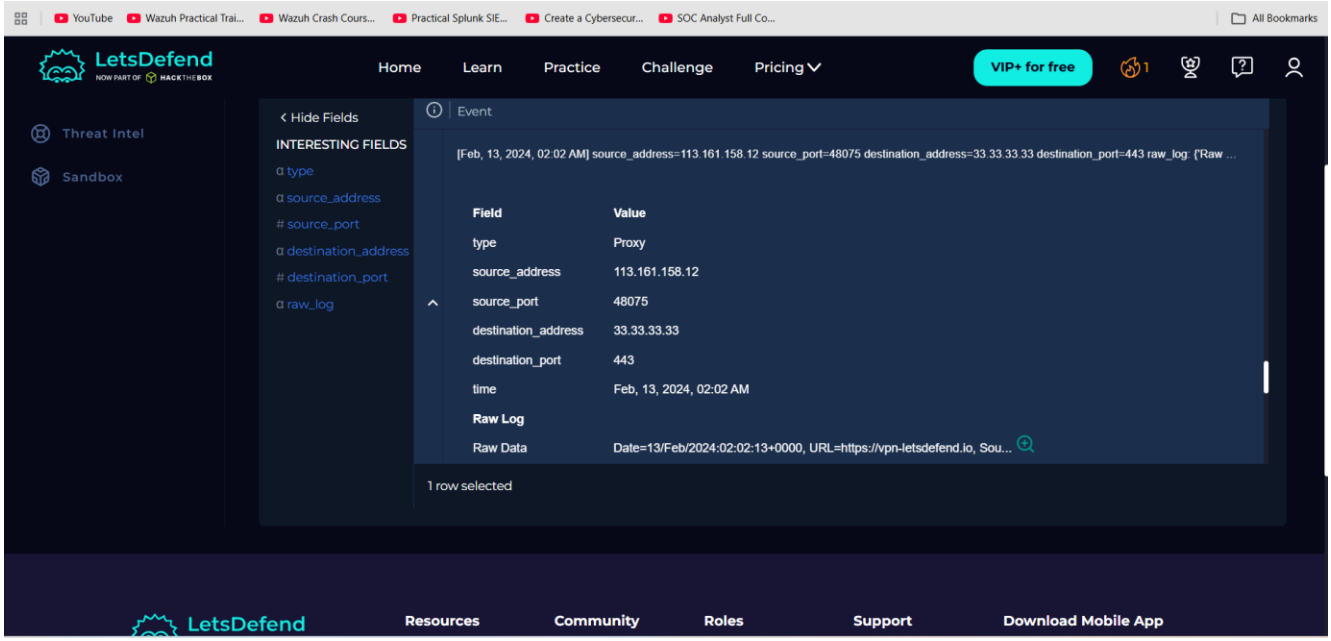
Verifying if Monica sent an email regarding vacation or travel.



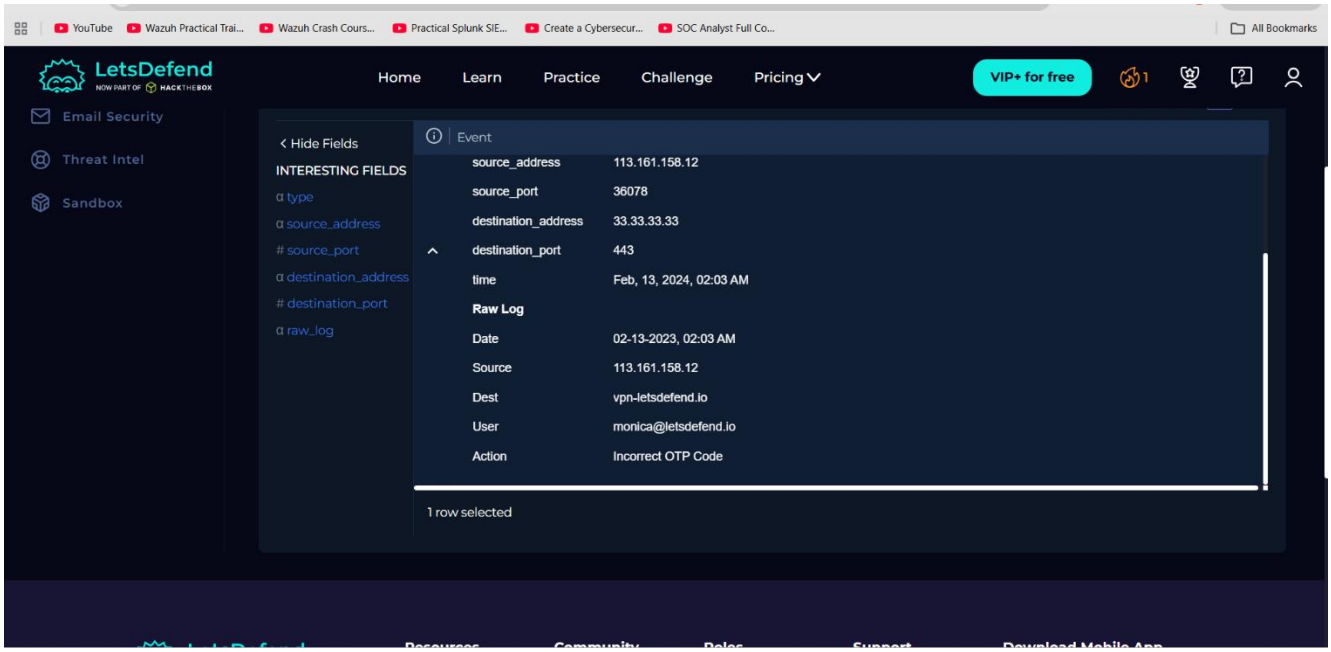


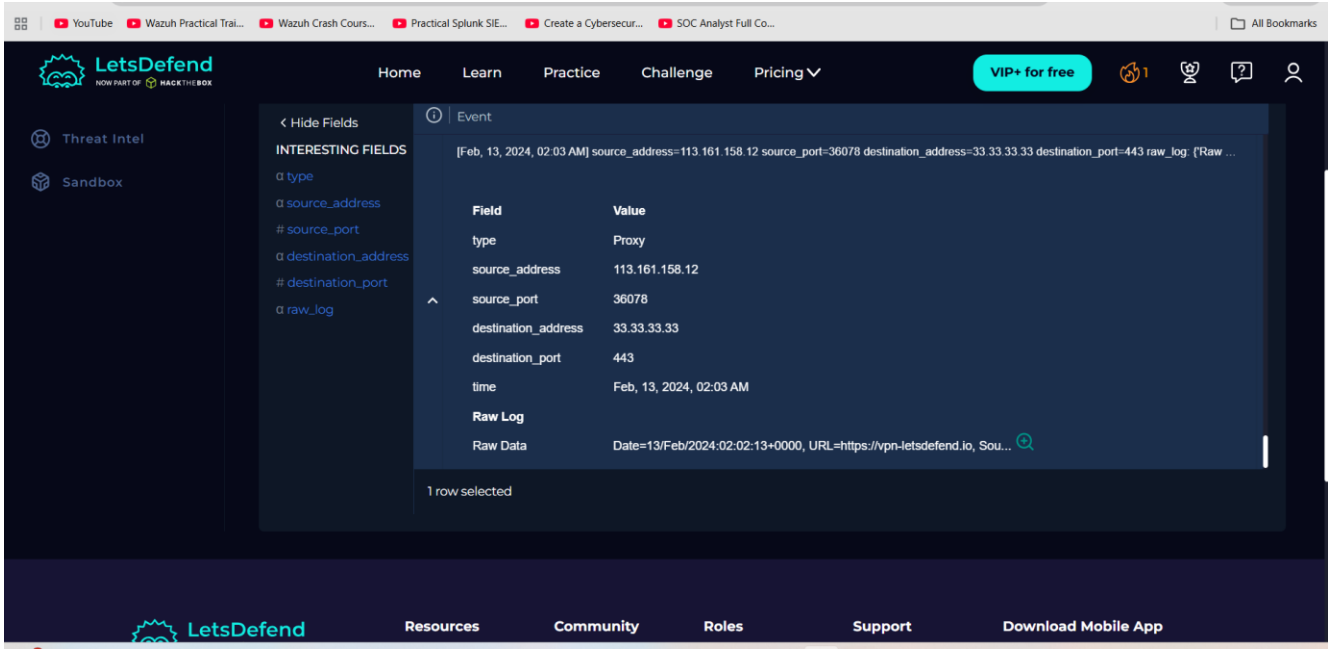
First MFA failure recorded as "Incorrect OTP Code" immediately followed by a successful authentication. Logs show Response Status: 200, indicating a successful login and an established VPN session



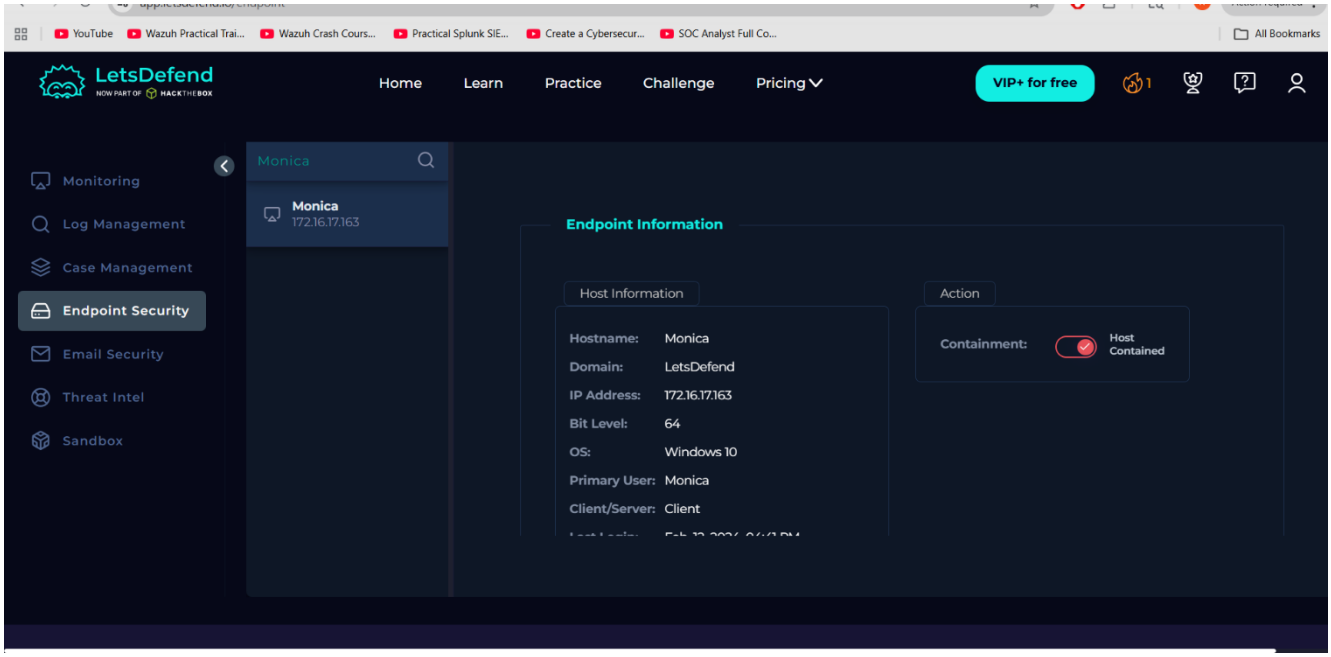


A second MFA failure occurred. The attacker successfully authenticated. Logs show Response Status: 200, indicating a successful login and an established VPN session.

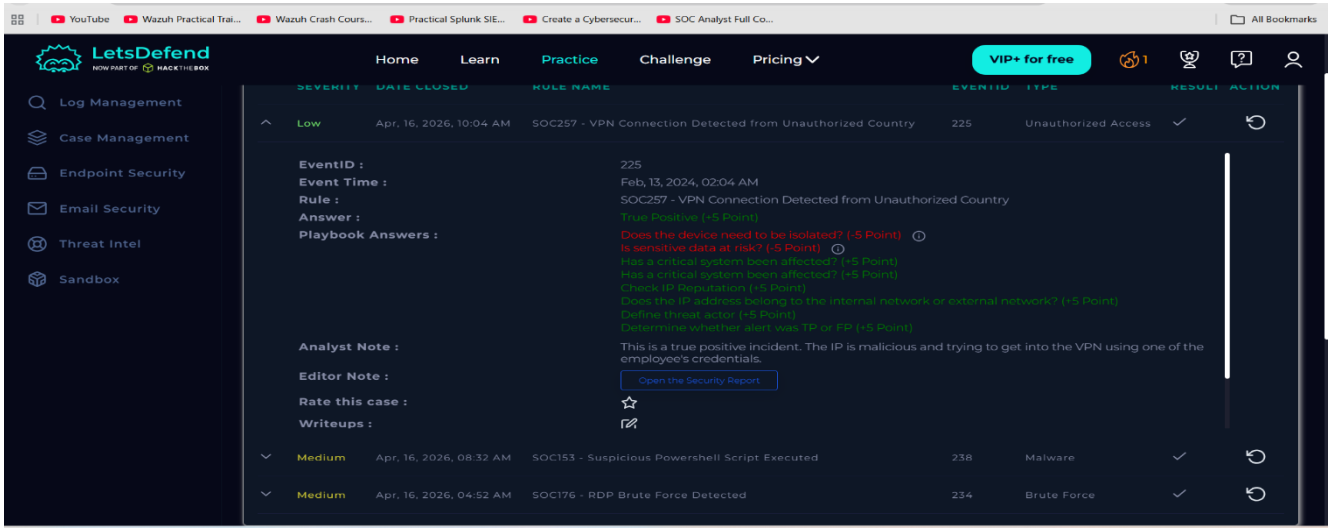




One final "Incorrect OTP Code" was also immediately followed by successful authentication. Logs show Response Status: 200, indicating a successful login and an established VPN session.



After the detection, the host was isolated.



The Summary of the findings.

6. Recommendations & Remediation

Short-Term actions:

1. IP Blocking: Block the malicious source IP 113.161.158.12 at the Firewall perimeter/VPN gateway.
2. Credential reset: Reset the credentials of the compromised account.
3. Full scan: Perform a full forensic scan of Monica's workstation to ensure no persistence mechanisms were installed.

Long-Term actions:

1. Geographic Fencing: Policy to block VPN Connection attempts from countries where the company has no business or employees.
2. MFA Rate Limiting: Configure authentication system to temporarily lock an account after multiple failed OTP attempts to prevent automated spraying or fatigue attacks.
3. No work policy: Enforce a policy where no work should be allowed outside of your Country and can't carry the laptop.
4. User Awareness Training: Conduct User Awareness training on MFA Push Spam and how to report unauthorized approvals to SOC team immediately.